ERA 19

The Cold War Begins

1945 – 1949

Origins · containment · the struggle for Europe

ESSENTIAL QUESTION

How did wartime allies become Cold War enemies—and how did the U.S. respond?

KEY TERMS

The Iron Curtain · containment · the Truman Doctrine · the Marshall Plan · the Berlin Airlift · NATO

ALIGNED TO

CED Topic 8.2 · AMSCO Ch. 8.2

FROM ALLIES TO ADVERSARIES

An Uneasy Peace

Two Superpowers Collide

I

Rival Systems

U.S. **democracy and capitalism** vs. Soviet **communism**.

II

A Broken Alliance

The wartime partnership dissolved amid mutual suspicion.

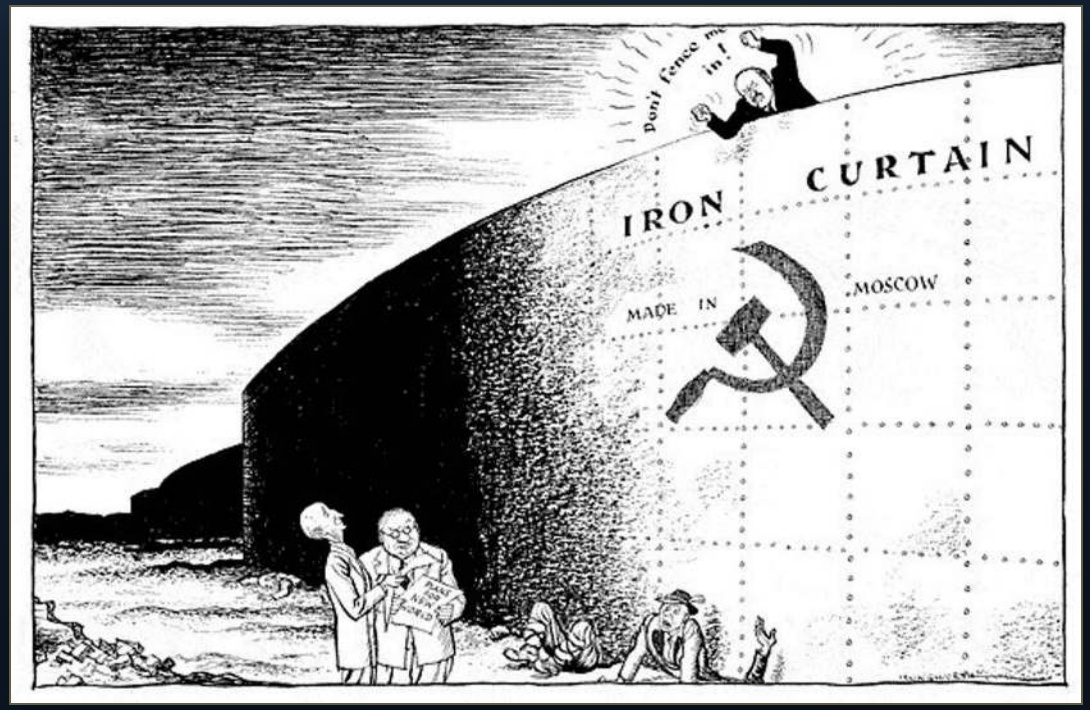
III

A New Kind of War

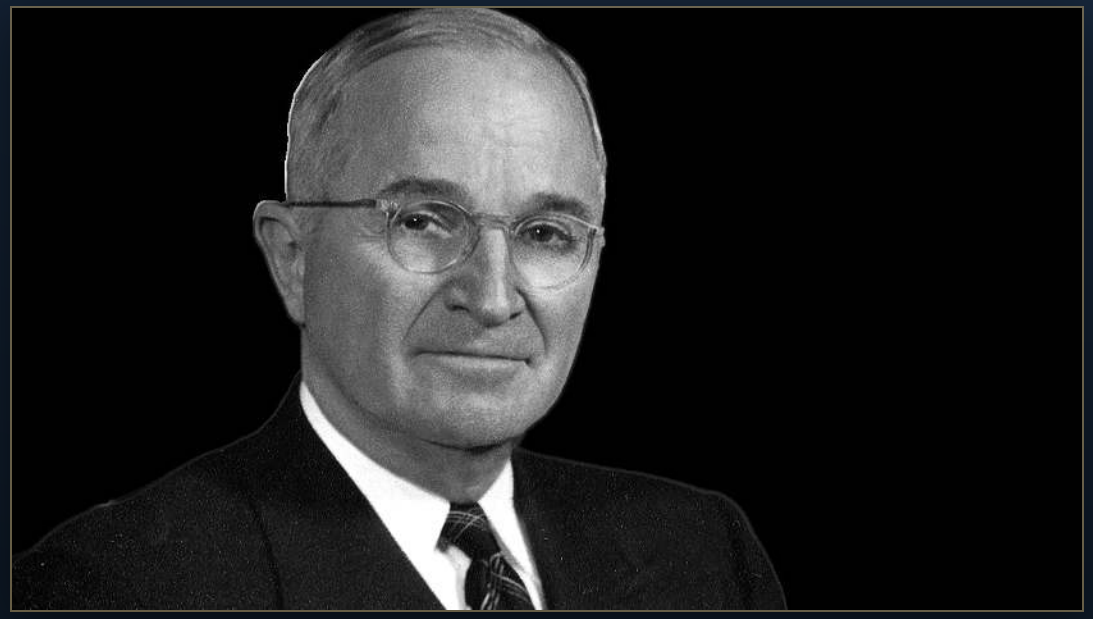
A tense global rivalry—fought with ideology, aid, and threats, not direct battle.

The Iron Curtain

- The Soviets installed communist governments across Eastern Europe—their '**satellite states**.'
- In 1946, **Winston Churchill** warned that an '**Iron Curtain**' had fallen across Europe.
- The continent was split into two hostile camps.



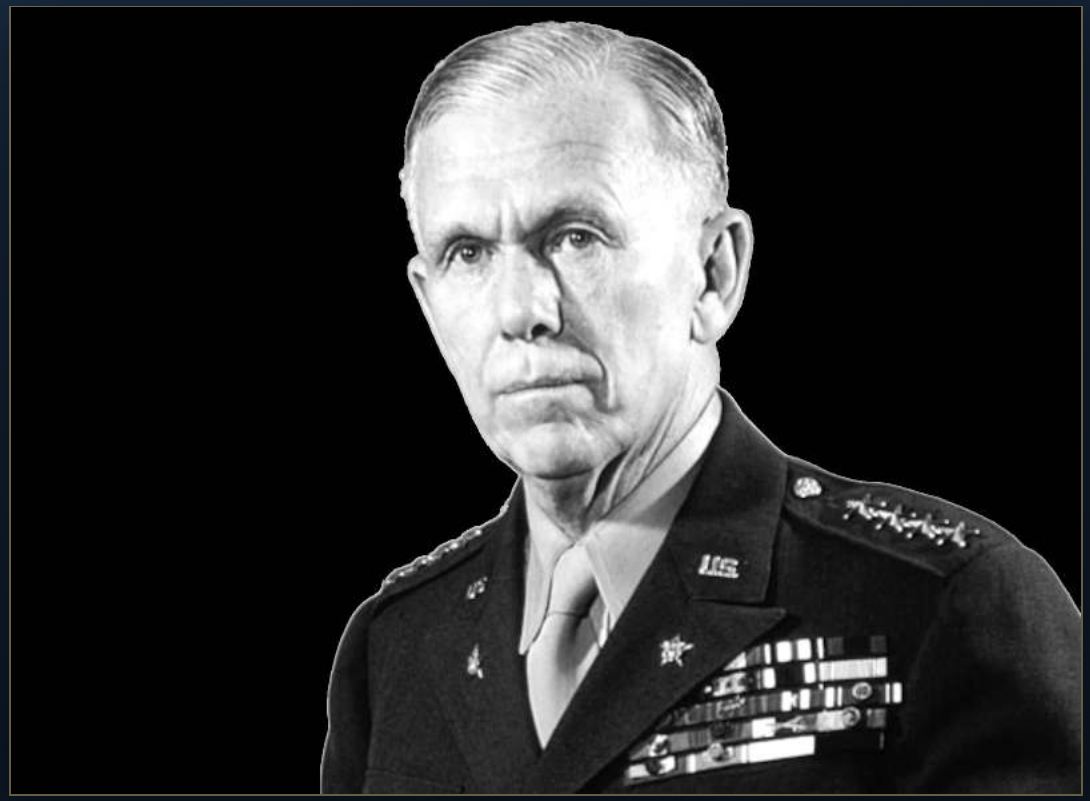
The Truman Doctrine



- In 1947, communists threatened **Greece** and **Turkey**.
- President Truman pledged to aid nations resisting **communism**.
- The **Truman Doctrine** made **containment** official U.S. policy.

The Marshall Plan

- War had left much of Europe in ruins—fertile ground for **communism**.
- The **Marshall Plan** sent over $13 billion to rebuild Western Europe.
- Prosperity, the U.S. believed, was the best defense against **communism**.



SECTION

Flashpoint Berlin

The Berlin Airlift



- In 1948, the Soviets blockaded West Berlin, deep inside East Germany.
- The U.S. and Britain flew in supplies for nearly a year—the **Berlin Airlift**.
- The Soviets backed down, and Berlin became a symbol of the **Cold War**.

NATO & a Divided World

- In 1949, the U.S. and its allies formed **NATO**—a military alliance.
- The Soviets later answered with the Warsaw Pact.
- The world settled into two rival, heavily armed blocs.



KEY TAKEAWAYS

The Cold War Begins

1. Ideological and strategic rivalry turned the U.S. and USSR into **Cold War** enemies behind an **Iron Curtain**.
2. The U.S. adopted **containment**—through the **Truman Doctrine** and the **Marshall Plan**.
3. The **Berlin Airlift** and **NATO** hardened the division of Europe into two armed camps.

DISCUSS & APPLY

The Cold War Begins

AP HISTORICAL REASONING PRACTICE

CAUSATION

Explain how ideological and strategic differences turned the U.S. and USSR into **Cold War** rivals.

COMPARISON

Compare the **Truman Doctrine** and the **Marshall Plan** as tools of **containment**.

CONTINUITY & CHANGE

How did **containment** mark a break from earlier American **isolationism**?

Up next — **Class 53: The Cold War Turns Hot** (Korea & the Red Scare)